

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12407916
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 02, 2025
Inventor(s)	Lawrence; Peter et al.

Systems and methods for camera configuration

Abstract

Example implementations include a method, apparatus and computer-readable medium for configuring a camera, comprising generating, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information. The implementations further include receiving, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types. Additionally, the implementations further include determining NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type. Additionally, the implementations further include generating, for display on the GUI, a visual representation of the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings.

Inventors: Lawrence; Peter (Lisburn, GB), Anderson; Benjamin Campbell (Belfast, GB), Neill; Terence (Lisburn, GB)

Applicant: Tyco Fire & Security GmbH (Neuhausen am Rheinfall, WI)

Family ID: 85979450

Assignee: Tyco Fire & Security GmbH (Neuhausen am Rheinfall, CH)

Appl. No.: 18/120883

Filed: March 13, 2023

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230300447 A1	Sep. 21, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63269586 20220318

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04N23/63 (20230101); G06F3/00 (20060101); G06F21/70 (20130101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H04N23/631 (20230101); G06F3/005 (20130101); G06F21/70 (20130101);

Field of Classification Search

USPC: 386/291

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
10013548	12/2017	Oberheide	N/A	G06F 21/40
10475315	12/2018	Madar et al.	N/A	N/A
10638096	12/2019	Lin	N/A	G08B 13/19656
10846960	12/2019	Lemberger	N/A	G06V 20/63
10855469	12/2019	Doyon	N/A	H04L 63/083
10887562	12/2020	Ellerhold et al.	N/A	N/A
11004319	12/2020	Schieltz et al.	N/A	N/A
11190737	12/2020	Dubois	N/A	H04N 23/90
12002338	12/2023	Jolivet	N/A	G08B 13/19656
12041131	12/2023	Pope	N/A	H04W 4/021
2010/0110212	12/2009	Kuwahara	348/148	H04N 23/60
2017/0180624	12/2016	Renkis	N/A	N/A
2017/0186290	12/2016	Li	N/A	G08B 13/19645
2017/0264608	12/2016	Moore	N/A	G07C 9/257
2017/0278365	12/2016	Madar	N/A	H04N 7/181
2017/0280043	12/2016	Burke et al.	N/A	N/A
2017/0280488	12/2016	Kawasaki	N/A	H04L 61/5007
2018/0063120	12/2017	Kim	N/A	H04L 67/141
2018/0070001	12/2017	Nassor	N/A	G06V 20/52
2018/0096175	12/2017	Schmeling	N/A	G06F 1/3206
2019/0245713	12/2018	Lo	N/A	H04L 12/2834
2019/0258864	12/2018	Lee	N/A	G06T 11/206
2019/0318382	12/2018	Yang	N/A	G06Q 20/326
2019/0354921	12/2018	Bolta	N/A	H04W 4/33
2020/0193787	12/2019	Jolivet	N/A	G08B 13/19656
2022/0058393	12/2021	Calvert et al.	N/A	N/A
2023/0079451	12/2022	Drako	348/143	H04W 4/029

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
3896956	12/2020	EP	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Primary Examiner: Chowdhury; Nigar

Attorney, Agent or Firm: ArentFox Schiff LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/269,586, filed Mar. 18, 2022, which is herein incorporated by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The described aspects relate to camera systems.

BACKGROUND

(2) Aspects of the present disclosure relate generally to camera systems, and more particularly, to configuring a new camera.

(3) Some of the most expensive activities in installing a video security system are software provisioning and configuration. This applies to all devices, but is particularly important when there is a large number of similar devices (e.g., security cameras). There are a number of challenges including device discovery, network configuration, network video recorder (NVR) connection, etc. In terms of device discovery, cameras are connected to a network and are “headless,” which means that an installer has to find out the IP address of each camera before he/she can access the configuration menu. In terms of network configuration, cameras are predominantly installed on an isolated network and require a static IP Address to be configured. This adds management overhead as someone needs to record and maintain the list of devices and corresponding IP addresses. It also introduces the potential for human error as someone has to manually configure the camera to match the entry in their list. In terms of an NVR connection, each camera must then be manually “added” to its corresponding NVR in order to stream. This is most commonly done on a per camera basis. There are NVR features to support bulk adding, but creating the input file is currently a manual process. After discovery, each camera must be manually configured with details of the customer account before it will start streaming to the cloud and in turn be visible on a cloud system (e.g., the CloudVue system).

(4) Conventional camera systems are unable to address these issues. Accordingly, there exists a need for improvements in such camera systems.

SUMMARY

(5) The following presents a simplified summary of one or more aspects in order to provide a basic understanding of such aspects. This summary is not an extensive overview of all contemplated aspects, and is intended to neither identify key or critical elements of all aspects nor delineate the scope of any or all aspects. Its sole purpose is to present some concepts of one or more aspects in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented later.

(6) An example aspect includes a method for configuring a camera, comprising generating, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information. The method further includes receiving, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types. Additionally, the method further includes determining NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type. Additionally, the method further includes

generating, for display on the GUI, a visual representation of the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings.

(7) Another example aspect includes an apparatus for configuring a camera, comprising a memory and a processor communicatively coupled with the memory. The processor is configured to generate, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information. The processor is further configured to receive, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types. Additionally, the processor further configured to determine NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type. Additionally, the processor further configured to generate, for display on the GUI, a visual representation of the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings.

(8) Another example aspect includes an apparatus for configuring a camera, comprising means for generating, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information. The apparatus further includes means for receiving, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types. Additionally, the apparatus further includes means for determining NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type. Additionally, the apparatus further includes means for generating, for display on the GUI, a visual representation of the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings.

(9) Another example aspect includes a computer-readable medium having stored instructions for configuring a camera, wherein the instructions are executable by a processor to generate, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information. The instructions are further executable to receive, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types. Additionally, the instructions are further executable to determine NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type. Additionally, the instructions are further executable to generate, for display on the GUI, a visual representation of the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings.

(10) To the accomplishment of the foregoing and related ends, the one or more aspects comprise the features hereinafter fully described and particularly pointed out in the claims. The following description and the annexed drawings set forth in detail certain illustrative features of the one or more aspects. These features are indicative, however, of but a few of the various ways in which the principles of various aspects may be employed, and this description is intended to include all such aspects and their equivalents.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The accompanying drawings, which are incorporated into and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate one or more example aspects of the present disclosure and, together with the detailed description, serve to explain their principles and implementations.

(2) FIG. 1 is a diagram of an environment in which different cameras are to be set up, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 2 is a diagram of a system for configuring a new camera, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram of a computing device executing a camera setup component, in

accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart illustrating a method of configuring a new camera, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a flowchart illustrating a method of verifying that a computing device is authorized to display a visual representation, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 6 is a flowchart illustrating a method of determining video settings for inclusion in the configuration information, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

(8) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method of storing encrypted configuration information in a memory card or a flash drive, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) Various aspects are now described with reference to the drawings. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of one or more aspects. It may be evident, however, that such aspect(s) may be practiced without these specific details.

(10) One issue with camera installations, such as in a video security system, is that each individual camera is added to a network video recorder (NVR). Since every camera has a different IP address, installers now need to know each camera IP before they can start adding cameras to the NVR. This means that installers need to discover the camera and configure the IP address. Discovery is rife with challenges, including multiple subnets and layer 2 (L2) switches blocking broadcast traffic. In fact, there may be requirements for camera discovery to be limited or even disabled by default. All of this leads to wasted money and/or time, a lack of security, and/or installer frustration.

(11) To overcome one or more of these issues, the present disclosure includes apparatuses and methods for configuring a new camera. In particular, a user may select an NVR type from a plurality of NVR types on a GUI presented on a computing device (e.g., a smartphone). A camera setup component installed on the computing device may determine NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type, and generate a visual representation (e.g., a QR code) of the configuration information comprising the NVR settings. The visual representation may be displayed on the computing device for capture by the camera. When the camera captures the visual representation, the camera may convert the visual representation into the configuration information and apply the NVR settings for setup. Thus, the present disclosure provides apparatuses and methods that may improve the ease and efficiency of installing a new camera.

(12) FIG. 1 is a diagram **100** of environment **102** in which different cameras are to be set up, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure. For example, but not limited hereto, environment **102** may be a construction site or a dock. Camera **104** and camera **106** may be security cameras that are mounted in different locations of environment **102**. It should be noted that any number of cameras may be installed in environment **102**, but only two are shown for simplicity. If a user intends to set up the cameras using methods of the present disclosure, the user may use a computing device such as a smartphone or a laptop to provide configuration information to the cameras. This configuration information may be provided using a physical transfer (e.g., installing a memory card into the cameras, inserting a flash drive into the cameras, etc.) or using a wireless transfer (e.g., displaying a QR code on the computing device for visual capture by the cameras).

(13) FIG. 2 is a diagram of system **200** for configuring a new camera, in accordance with exemplary aspects of the present disclosure. Elaborating on the description of diagram **100**, configuration information for camera **106** may be provided by a camera setup component (described in FIG. 3). The camera setup component may generate a GUI on computing device **202** and the user may interact with the GUI to select their desired settings to include in the configuration information of camera **106**. In some aspects, the camera setup component may then store the configuration information on external device **208** (e.g., a memory card or a USB drive) that can be connected to camera **106**. For example, the configuration information may be a plain

text file. In some aspects, when generating text files for a plurality of cameras, the camera setup component may store the text files in a ZIP file.

(14) In some aspects, the camera setup component may generate a visual representation of the configuration information. For example, the camera setup component may generate configuration code **204**. In some aspects, camera details **206** may accompany configuration code **204** to indicate which camera needs to be presented with configuration code **204**. For example, in diagram **200**, camera details **206** indicate a customer identifier “Harland & Wolf,” a site “Belfast Docks,” a location “building 6, main lobby,” a camera name “front entrance,” a camera IP address “192.168.1.168,” a camera model “Illustra IPS02-D12-OI03,” and an NVR type “VideoEdge 7.” A user may place the screen of computing device **202** in the line of sight of camera **106**, which may be configured to capture configuration code **204** and convert the code to the configuration information. Accordingly, a user is able to set up camera **106** without going through a wireless discovery process. The camera **106** may then be powered off and connected to a deployment network (or rebooted). Once the camera **106** reboots, it will automatically connect to the NVR via an application programming interface (API) and “add” itself based on the configuration information.

(15) In some aspects, the camera setup component supports outputting configuration code **204** as a QR code with the following specification: Version 10, 57×57 Modules, Correction Level H, and Support for 174 Characters. The visual representation may be presented on an A4 page PDF layout with a minimum DPI for the QR code of 600 DPI. In some aspects, the layout allows for multiple QR pages to be exported as a single PDF.

(16) It should be noted that for cameras with motorized lenses, a camera will often drift out of focus during transit. To ensure that the lenses are focused when the user is trying to display a configuration code, a software triggered auto-focus may be applied to all unconfigured cameras as they boot up. This auto-focus may be dependent on zoom levels. For example, due to the optics travel, Johnson Controls' ILLUSTRRA cameras all ship with zoom in the middle position. The auto-focus may be configured such that during an auto-focus attempt, the outer element of the lens does not touch the outer tape used in packaging.

(17) In terms of external devices, external device **208** may be a memory device, such as a memory card, readable by a personal computer and a camera (e.g., executing Linux or another operating system). Accordingly, the most widely used memory format (e.g., FAT32) may be used for external devices. In some aspects, the camera may re-format the card later, to be used for traditional camera functionality (e.g., onboard recording). Formatting external device **208** subsequent to setup may also prevent the configuration information from being accessed by an unauthorized entity (e.g., a hacker) that gains possession of external device **208**. Otherwise, the unauthorized entity may determine security settings and exploit the camera for their own purposes.

(18) Security is therefore one of the focuses of the present disclosure. The outputs from the camera setup component may contain sensitive information. For configuration codes, the camera setup component may offer the option to have the codes displayed on a mobile device (e.g., a tablet, a phone) so that the risk of them being misplaced is lessened. For external devices **208**, the camera setup component may encrypt the file so that it cannot be accessed by anyone else. The decryption key may be pre-programmed into the default camera, which needs to know the key without any user configuration. For example, each camera may be shipped with a public key and a private key. In one approach, a user may plug in external device **208** into camera **106**, which may be configured to automatically store the public key onto external device **208** when it is unconfigured (e.g., when the camera is in a factory setting). The camera setup component on computing device **202** may receive the public key via external device **208**, and may encrypt the configuration file using the public key. The encrypted file may then be stored on external device **208** for transfer to camera **106**. Camera **106** may decrypt the encrypted file using its private key and execute the configuration file.

(19) If multiple cameras are being setup by the same external device **208** (e.g., a memory card), each file comprising configuration information may be encrypted such that only the camera that is designated a particular configuration information file will be able to decrypt the file. For example, multiple public keys can be gathered via external device **208**. Each public key may be stored in a directory that is specific to a camera. The camera setup component on computing device **202** may store the configuration file for a particular camera in the directory associated with the camera and encrypt the stored configuration file. The external device **208** can thus be removed and connected to multiple cameras for efficient multi-camera setups. Each camera will only be able to successfully decrypt one configuration file using its private key—that configuration file is the one encrypted using its public key. For both options, a best practice guide that the system should be configured with interim (staging) credentials may be issued and then migrated to new credentials as the final stage of commissioning.

(20) Referring to FIG. **3** and FIG. **4**, in operation, computing device **300** may perform a method **400** of wireless communication, by such as via execution of camera setup component **315** by processor **305** and/or memory **310**.

(21) At block **402**, the method **400** includes generating, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or generating component **320** may be configured to or may comprise means for generating, for display on computing device **202**, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring camera **106**, wherein camera **106** is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information.

(22) In some aspects, the GUI is a web-based portal that supports user accounts (with password protection) and has the ability to create, save, and retrieve setup projects for one or more environments. For example, a user may be able to configure a camera for a first environment using the GUI and may also be able to configure another camera for a second environment using the same GUI by accessing a particular user account linked to both environments. The first environment may be an office space and the second environment may be a home space.

(23) At block **404**, the method **400** includes receiving, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or receiving component **325** may be configured to or may comprise means for receiving, by the GUI, a selection of a NVR type (e.g., VideoEdge 7) from a plurality of NVR types (e.g., CloudVue, Exacq, VideoEdge, etc.).

(24) For example, a user may select VideoEdge 7 as the NVR type from a dropdown menu on the GUI listing the plurality of NVR types.

(25) At block **406**, the method **400** includes determining NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or determining component **330** may be configured to or may comprise means for determining NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type.

(26) In an aspect, the NVR settings of a first NVR type from the plurality of NVR types comprises: a host identifier, a username, a password, a camera security level, a camera IP address, and wherein the NVR settings of a second NVR type from the plurality of NVR types comprises: the host identifier, the username, the password, the camera security level, the camera IP address, and a security group identifier.

(27) In a more specific example, Johnson Controls' CloudVue video surveillance and access control system deployments may include configuration of one or more of the following options: Partner Number, Data Center, HostID, New Username, New Password, Camera Security Level, Camera IP Address, Subnet, DNS, Gateway, Camera Name, and/or NVR Details. Johnson Controls' VideoEdge system may include configuration of the following options: HostID, New Username,

New Password, Camera Security Level, Camera IP Address, Subnet, DNS, Gateway, Camera Name, VideoEdge IP Address, VideoEdge Username, VideoEdge Password, VideoEdge Security Group.

(28) In an aspect, determining the NVR settings comprises receiving the NVR settings via the GUI. For example, the user may provide the exact values of pre-determined attributes of an NVR type. For example, the user may provide, via manual input (e.g., typing, pressing, speaking, gestures, etc.), values for HostID, Username, Password, etc., that are to be assigned to the new camera.

(29) In an aspect, determining the NVR settings comprises loading pre-selected NVR settings from saved NVR profiles on the computing device. For example, camera setup component **315** may generate a default NVR profile for each NVR type. The default NVR profile may include values for each of the NVR settings associated with each NVR type. In some aspects, the user may be interested in configuring multiple cameras of the same NVR type. To prevent duplicate NVR setting values for each newly configured camera, camera setup component **315** may randomize or increment each value. For example, if the username for a first camera is “camera1,” the username for a second camera may be set to “camera2.” Camera setup component **315** may thus track the number of cameras being configured in order to prevent duplicate configurations (e.g., cameras with the same IP address).

(30) At block **408**, the method **400** includes generating, for display on the GUI, a visual representation of the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or generating component **335** may be configured to or may comprise means for generating, for display on the GUI, a visual representation (e.g., configuration code **204**) of the configuration information for camera **106**, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings.

(31) In an aspect, the visual representation is one of: a QR code, a barcode, and a bitmap.

(32) In an aspect, computing device **202** may serve as a web server. For example, camera setup component **315** on computing device **202** may be configured to host a website that stores the configuration information required to configure camera **106**. The visual representation that is scanned by camera **106** may point to the website. For example, computing device **202** may output a QR code that points to a website hosted by computing device **202**. When camera **106** scans the QR code, camera **106** connects to the website and can begin downloading the configuration information.

(33) In order to ensure that the configuration information on the website is not accessed by other devices, camera setup component **315** may encrypt the configuration information such that only camera **106** can decrypt the configuration information. This encryption approach may involve private and public key exchanges as described previously. In some aspects, camera setup component **315** may generate a first QR code that points to a website that receives (e.g., via an upload) a public key of camera **106**. Subsequent to scanning the first QR code, camera **106** may upload its public key to camera setup component **315**. Camera setup component **315** may then generate configuration information, as described in method **400**, and encrypt the configuration information with the public key. Camera setup component **315** may then generate a second QR code the points to a website storing the encrypted configuration information. Subsequent to scanning the second QR code, camera **106** may download and decrypt the encrypted configuration information from the website using its private key and execute the configuration details.

(34) In an aspect, a first visual representation is generated for a first camera (e.g., camera **104**) and a second visual representation is generated for a second camera (e.g., camera **106**). For example, camera setup component **315** may generate a first QR code specific to camera **104** and a second QR code specific to camera **106**.

(35) Referring to FIG. 5, in an optional aspect, at block **502**, the method **400** may further include verifying that the computing device is authorized to display the visual representation. For example,

in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or verifying component **340** may be configured to or may comprise means for verifying that computing device **202** is authorized to display the visual representation. For example, an unauthorized person may maliciously attempt to reprogram a camera using a visual representation on his/her computing device. This occurrence can be detected if the computing device is not recognized as an authorized computing device. Verifying component **340** may determine that a computing device is authorized by determining whether the computing device is logged in (with proper user credentials) to camera setup component **315**.

(36) Referring to FIG. **6**, in an optional aspect, at block **602**, the method **400** may further include receiving, by the GUI, a selection of camera type. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or receiving component **345** may be configured to or may comprise means for receiving, by the GUI, a selection of camera type. For example, the camera may be of a certain model that has a various capabilities (e.g., a maximum resolution, a maximum zoom level, night mode, etc.). In some aspects, the camera type may be a camera model number or a media access control (MAC) address.

(37) In this optional aspect, at block **604**, the method **400** may further include determining, for inclusion in the configuration information, video settings for the camera based on the camera type. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or determining component **350** may be configured to or may comprise means for determining, for inclusion in the configuration information, video settings for the camera based on the camera type.

(38) In an aspect, the video settings comprise a stream quality level (e.g., high, medium, low), a resolution (e.g., 720p), a bandwidth (e.g., high, medium, low), an amount of frames to capture per second (e.g., 60 fps), and environment modes (e.g., outdoor, indoor, night, gaming, etc.).

(39) In some aspects, camera setup component **315** may further configure a camera network (e.g., DHCP/Static). In some aspects, a camera may update its IP address on the VMS (DHCP & Cloud scenario).

(40) Referring to FIG. **7**, in an optional aspect, the method **400** may further include encrypting the configuration information. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or encrypting component **355** may be configured to or may comprise means for encrypting the configuration information.

(41) For example, encrypting component **355** may apply algorithms such as Advanced Encryption Standard (AES), Rivet-Shamir-Adleman (RSA), Triple Data Encryption Standard (DES) to prevent the configuration information from be accessed by unauthorized users (e.g., a hacker attempting access the cameras).

(42) In this aspect, at block **704**, the method **400** may further include storing the encrypted configuration information in a memory card or a flash drive. For example, in an aspect, computing device **300**, processor **305**, memory **310**, camera setup component **315**, and/or storing component **360** may be configured to or may comprise means for storing the encrypted configuration information in a memory card or a flash drive (e.g., external drive **208**).

(43) It should be noted that the camera setup component **315** may send the alarm events via the same mechanism as is used today for A.I., Object Classification (i.e., Engine ID 4). In some aspects, the camera setup component may export a CSV file for manual upload to an NVR (e.g., VideoEdge). This may disable a camera from adding itself (GUI configuration only). The camera automatically uploads a configuration to Johnson Controls' VideoEdge system and automatically connects to Johnson Controls' CloudVue system, although other systems may be utilized.

(44) While the foregoing disclosure discusses illustrative aspects and/or embodiments, it should be noted that various changes and modifications could be made herein without departing from the scope of the described aspects and/or embodiments as defined by the appended claims.

Furthermore, although elements of the described aspects and/or embodiments may be described or

claimed in the singular, the plural is contemplated unless limitation to the singular is explicitly stated. Additionally, all or a portion of any aspect and/or embodiment may be utilized with all or a portion of any other aspect and/or embodiment, unless stated otherwise.

Claims

1. A method for configuring a camera, comprising: generating, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information; receiving, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types; determining NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type; and generating the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings, wherein a camera setup component on the computing device is configured to host a website that stores the configuration information for the camera; generating, by the camera setup component for display on the GUI, a first visual representation that points to the website that receives a public key of the camera; subsequent to scanning the first visual representation by the camera, receiving, at the camera setup component from the camera, the public key of the camera; encrypting, by the camera setup component, the configuration information with the public key such that only the camera can decrypt the configuration information; generating, by the camera setup component for display on the GUI, a second visual representation that points to the website storing the encrypted configuration information, the second visual representation, when scanned by the camera, enabling the camera to: download and decrypt the encrypted configuration information from the website using a private key of the camera; and execute the configuration information.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the first visual representation is one of: a QR code, a barcode, and a bitmap.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein a visual representation is generated for a first camera and a different visual representation is generated for a second camera.
4. The method of claim 1, further comprising verifying that the computing device is authorized to display the first visual representation, wherein the first visual representation is not generated for display on unauthorized computing devices.
5. The method of claim 1, further comprising: receiving, by the GUI, a selection of camera type; and determining, for inclusion in the configuration information, video settings for the camera based on the camera type.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein the video settings comprise a stream quality level, a resolution, a bandwidth, an amount of frames to capture per second, and environment modes.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the NVR settings comprises receiving the NVR settings via the GUI.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein determining the NVR settings comprises loading pre-selected NVR settings from saved NVR profiles on the computing device.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein NVR settings of a first NVR type from the plurality of NVR types comprises: a host identifier, a username, a password, a camera security level, a camera IP address, and wherein NVR settings of a second NVR type from the plurality of NVR types comprises: the host identifier, the username, the password, the camera security level, the camera IP address, and a security group identifier.
10. The method of claim 1, further comprising: storing the encrypted configuration information in a memory card or a flash drive.
11. An apparatus for configuring a camera, comprising: a memory; and a processor communicatively coupled with the memory and configured to: generate, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information; receive, by the GUI, a

selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types; determine NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type; and generate the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings, wherein a camera setup component on the computing device is configured to host a website that stores the configuration information for the camera; generate, by the camera setup component for display on the GUI, a first visual representation that points to the website that receives a public key of the camera; subsequent to scanning the first visual representation by the camera, receive, at the camera setup component from the camera, the public key of the camera; encrypt, by the camera setup component, the configuration information with the public key such that only the camera can decrypt the configuration information; generate, by the camera setup component for display on the GUI, a second visual representation that points to the website storing the encrypted configuration information, the second visual representation, when scanned by the camera, enabling the camera to: download and decrypt the encrypted configuration information from the website using a private key of the camera; and execute the configuration information.

12. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the first visual representation is one of: a QR code, a barcode, and a bitmap.

13. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein a visual representation is generated for a first camera and a different visual representation is generated for a second camera.

14. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor is further configured to verifying that the computing device is authorized to display the first visual representation, wherein the first visual representation is not generated for display on unauthorized computing devices.

15. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor is further configured to: receive, by the GUI, a selection of camera type; and determine, for inclusion in the configuration information, video settings for the camera based on the camera type.

16. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the video settings comprise a stream quality level, a resolution, a bandwidth, an amount of frames to capture per second, and environment modes.

17. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein to determine the NVR settings comprises to receive the NVR settings via the GUI.

18. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein to determine the NVR settings comprises loading pre-selected NVR settings from saved NVR profiles on the computing device.

19. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein NVR settings of a first NVR type from the plurality of NVR types comprises to: a host identifier, a username, a password, a camera security level, a camera IP address, and wherein NVR settings of a second NVR type from the plurality of NVR types comprises to: the host identifier, the username, the password, the camera security level, the camera IP address, and a security group identifier.

20. The apparatus of claim 11, wherein the processor is further configured to: store the encrypted configuration information in a memory card or a flash drive.

21. A computer-readable medium having stored instructions for configuring a camera, the instructions executable by a processor to: generate, for display on a computing device, a graphical user interface (GUI) for configuring a camera, wherein the camera is programmed to visually receive and execute configuration information; receive, by the GUI, a selection of a network video recorder (NVR) type from a plurality of NVR types; determine NVR settings for the camera based on the selection of the NVR type; and generate the configuration information for the camera, wherein the configuration information comprises the NVR settings, wherein a camera setup component on the computing device is configured to host a website that stores the configuration information for the camera; generate, by the camera setup component for display on the GUI, a first visual representation that points to the website that receives a public key of the camera; subsequent to scanning the first visual representation by the camera, receive, at the camera setup component from the camera, the public key of the camera; encrypt, by the camera setup component, the configuration information with the public key such that only the camera can decrypt the

configuration information; generate, by the camera setup component for display on the GUI, a second visual representation that points to the website storing the encrypted configuration information, the second visual representation, when scanned by the camera, enabling the camera to: download and decrypt the encrypted configuration information from the website using a private key of the camera; and execute the configuration information.
